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Company Equipment and Home Office Equipment

Educational and synthetic policy corpus. Northstar Technologies Inc. is a fictional company created for an AI engineering project. All people, records, email addresses, examples, and operational data are synthetic. These documents are not legal advice and do not replace applicable law, benefit plan documents, signed employment agreements, or case-specific guidance from People Operations.

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Applies to	Employees and authorized contingent workers issued company equipment or approved for home-office support
Classification	Internal

EQP-1. Purpose

This policy defines standard equipment, ownership, procurement, home-office support, connectivity stipends, acceptable use, repair, replacement, loss, and return. Its goals are to provide reliable tools, control cost, protect information, and maintain accurate asset records.

EQP-2. Ownership and approved procurement

Equipment purchased or supplied by Northstar remains company property unless a written transfer says otherwise. Employees may not sell, pledge, donate, dispose of, or permanently modify company equipment.

IT procures standard technology. Employees must not purchase laptops, monitors, phones, software, cloud services, or security devices with an expectation of reimbursement unless IT and the required budget approver have approved the purchase in advance.

EQP-3. Standard equipment by work designation

Actual configuration depends on role and availability.

Work designation	Standard technology kit
Office-Based	Company laptop, charger, dock or office connection, access to office monitor and standard keyboard/mouse, role-required headset
Hybrid	Company laptop, charger, dock, one home monitor, standard keyboard/mouse, and headset when required
Remote	Company laptop, charger, dock, up to two monitors based on role, standard keyboard/mouse, headset, and webcam when needed

A role may require specialized hardware, mobile device, security key, testing equipment, or accessibility technology. Non-standard equipment requires the relevant system owner, IT, and budget approval.

EQP-4. Home-office furniture reimbursement

RFT and RPT employees with a current Hybrid or Remote designation may request preapproval for ergonomic furniture reimbursement up to **CAD 500 or USD 375 once every 36 months**. The combined limit may cover an approved chair, desk, footrest, keyboard tray, or similar ergonomic item.

The employee must submit the request before purchase and follow **POL-EXP-001**. Amounts above the limit are personal unless People Operations approves a workplace accommodation. Office-Based employees are not normally eligible because the assigned office is the primary workspace.

Reimbursed furniture normally becomes the employee's property and is not returned, unless the approval states that Northstar is purchasing and owning the item.

EQP-5. Internet and mobile connectivity

A Remote-designated employee may receive a monthly internet stipend of **CAD 50 or USD 40** through payroll or the approved stipend process. Hybrid and Office-Based employees are not normally eligible unless a written agreement or accommodation says otherwise.

The stipend supports ordinary service and does not require the employee to provide personal browsing history or a detailed household bill. It does not guarantee reimbursement of the full internet cost. Business travel connectivity is handled under **POL-EXP-001**.

Company-paid mobile service is role-based. Employees should not use a personal phone as the primary repository for company information. When personal mobile enrollment is approved, company data may be remotely removed without affecting personal content to the extent technically possible.

EQP-6. Asset records and custody

IT records the asset identifier, assigned user, serial number, configuration, issue date, and status. Employees must verify receipt and promptly report an error. Company devices should not be transferred between employees without IT authorization.

Equipment must be kept in a reasonably secure, clean, and ventilated location. Food, liquids, pets, children, visitors, and environmental conditions should be managed to reduce damage or unauthorized use.

EQP-7. Acceptable use and software

Limited incidental personal use is allowed when lawful, reasonable, secure, and not disruptive. Employees must not use equipment for unlawful activity, harassment, outside commercial work, cryptocurrency mining, unapproved high-risk software, or content that violates **POL-CON-001**.

Only approved software, extensions, and peripherals may be installed. Security controls, encryption, management agents, logs, and update settings must not be disabled.

EQP-8. Repair, replacement, and lifecycle

Employees should report faults through IT support and must not use an unapproved repair shop. IT decides whether to troubleshoot, repair, loan, or replace equipment.

Planning assumptions are a four-year laptop lifecycle and five-year monitor lifecycle, but replacement depends on security support, performance, condition, and business need. Lifecycle timing is not a personal entitlement to a new model.

Damage from normal use is covered by Northstar. Negligent, repeated, or intentional damage may be reviewed with People Operations, but managers must not deduct costs from pay without lawful authorization.

EQP-9. Loss, theft, and suspected compromise

Loss or theft of a company device, security key, badge, or phone used for MFA must be reported to IT/Security and the manager within one hour of discovery, following **POL-SEC-001**. The employee should provide location, time, device, and known circumstances and cooperate with remote lock, credential reset, police report, or insurer process.

Safety takes priority over recovering property. Employees must not confront a suspected thief.

EQP-10. International travel

Equipment taken outside the registered province, state, or country is subject to **POL-INT-001** and **POL-SEC-001**. Security may issue a temporary travel device, restrict data, or prohibit specific equipment. Employees must not place company equipment in checked baggage unless no safer option exists and Security has approved it.

EQP-11. Return and reassignment

Employees must return requested equipment in the condition reasonably expected from normal use:

- within seven calendar days after employment ends, unless the separation notice provides a shorter lawful period;
- before or promptly after a role or location change when IT requests different equipment; and
- immediately when access is suspended for a material security reason.

IT provides return instructions and, when appropriate, prepaid shipping. Employees must not wipe, reset, or discard a device before return.

EQP-12. Accessibility and accommodation

An employee who needs non-standard equipment for a disability, injury, or ergonomic restriction should contact People Operations. Accommodation-related equipment is assessed separately from the ordinary furniture cap and may require functional information, but not unnecessary diagnosis disclosure to the manager.

EQP-13. Responsibilities

Employees safeguard and return equipment. Managers identify role needs and approve legitimate non-standard requests. IT procures, supports, inventories, and disposes of assets. Security defines controls and incident response. Finance audits expenditures. People Operations handles accommodation and conduct questions.

EQP-14. Examples

- A Hybrid employee may receive one home monitor and may request a preapproved chair reimbursement up to CAD 500 once every 36 months.
- A Remote employee receives the standard internet stipend and may not also expense the same monthly internet charge.
- An employee may not buy a personal laptop and later ask for reimbursement because the company laptop was delayed.
- A stolen security key must be reported within one hour, even when no company files were stored on the key.

Related policies and records

- **POL-SEC-001 - Information Security for Remote Workers**
- **POL-RWK-001 - Remote and Hybrid Work Policy**
- **POL-EXP-001 - Business Expenses and Reimbursements**
- **POL-ONB-001 - New Employee Onboarding**